The `HttpContext` object also exposes the current *principal* for a request as the `User` property. This is ASP.NET Core's view of which user made the request. Any time your app needs to know who the current user is or what they're allowed to do, it can look at the `HttpContext.User` principal.

DEFINITION You can think of the *principal* as the user of your app.

In ASP.NET Core, principals are implemented using the `ClaimsPrincipal` class, which has a collection of *claims* associated with it, as shown in figure 23.1.

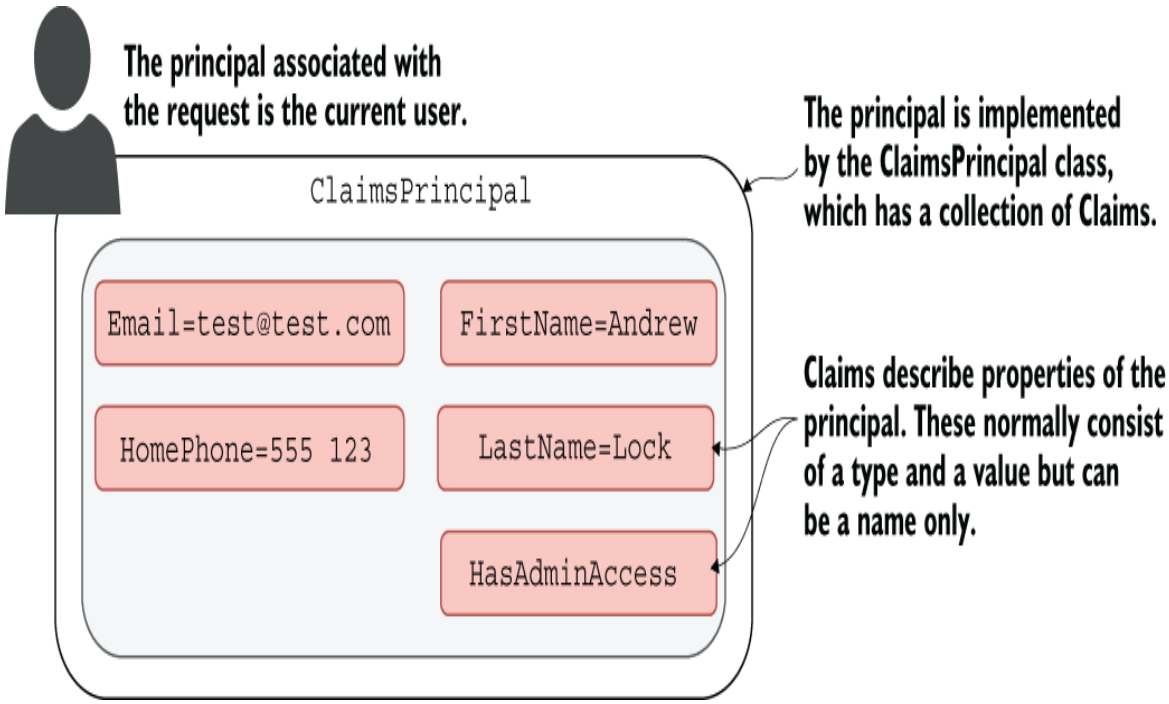


Figure 23.1 The principal is the current user, implemented as `ClaimsPrincipal`. It contains a collection of `Claims` that describe the user.

You can think about claims as properties of the current user. For example, you could have claims for things like email, name, and date of birth.